

**Teamwork as a strategic tool for Enhancing Revenue collection and compliance Within ZRA
with reference to Kazungula OSBP ZRA office.**

ABSTRACT

This study examined teamwork as a strategic means of improving revenue collection strategies at the Zambia Revenue Authority, Kazungula One Stop Border Post, with objectives to determine the extent of teamwork practice, establish key challenges affecting teamwork, and assess how effective teamwork influences the efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection. Adopting a convergent parallel mixed methods design, quantitative data were collected from 50 employees across Customs, Domestic Taxes, and Support Services departments using structured questionnaires and analyzed with SPSS version 29 through descriptive statistics, t-tests, ANOVA, correlation, and regression analysis. Findings established that teamwork is practiced to a high extent with an overall mean of 3.82, particularly in Customs Department, though gaps persist in role clarity and formal coordination mechanisms. Major challenges identified include competing performance targets across units, lack of resources, and poor interdepartmental communication, which negatively correlate with teamwork practice. Crucially, teamwork practice explained 45.3% of variance in revenue effectiveness with a strong positive correlation $r = 0.674$, $p < 0.001$, as respondents agreed that teamwork reduces assessment errors, accelerates target achievement, improves taxpayer compliance, and minimizes revenue leakages. The study concludes that while a collaborative culture exists, unsupportive organizational systems constrain impact, and recommends harmonizing performance targets, institutionalizing team structures, upgrading IT infrastructure, and conducting targeted training. The research contributes to knowledge by extending teamwork quality theory to revenue authorities and quantifying teamwork's impact at an African OSBP, providing evidence for team-based reforms in public sector domestic resource mobilization.

Keywords: *Teamwork, Revenue Collection, One Stop Border Post, Zambia Revenue Authority, Team Effectiveness, Public Sector, Domestic Resource Mobilization, Tax Administration*

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CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

Any government whose revenue collection is efficient, enables it to fund public goods and services, promote economic development and reduce borrowings from outside. Mobilizing domestic revenue for domestic budgets in many developing countries is done by public institutions including for Zambia, the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA). Nevertheless, in order to be successful, this is not only place on policy structures and technological systems, but it is also dependent on the internal human resources structure, that is teamwork (OECD, 2019).

With the identification of teamwork as increasing in importance in an organization, particularly in dynamic and complex operational environments like that of tax administrations, the concept of teamwork has been widely realized. Katzenbach and Smith (2005) stated that effective teams such as can help coordinate work, create innovative endeavor and generate accountability that is key to maximize the operational efficiency. Teamwork also helps these public revenue authorities to implement tax policies in a smooth manner, help to detect revenue leakage on timely basis and help improve upon the level of taxpayer compliance (Tanzi & Zee, 2001).

Interrelated with the mandate of the ZRA, is to point out the revenue collection strategies of the ZRA. However, research on the effect of teamwork as an organizational practice to these strategies is limited. As currently, the nature of revenue collection is collaborative, it involves multiple departments, units for dealing with taxpayers and management of enforcement divisions, the role of teamwork is much more worthy of more scrutiny. However, the prior studies mainly concentrated on tax policy, tax compliance and automation, while failing to incorporate internal teams dynamics in tax administration (Nkundabanyanga et al., 2017).

Therefore, this study assesses the role of teamwork in increasing revenue collection strategy at the Zambia Revenue Authority. The study attempts to understand how the internal collaboration of staff enhances the achievement of organizational objective and challenges associated with a team based work structure and ways to overcome set challenges to improve performance.

1.2 Background to the study

One important role of government is that it collects revenue which is used to provide the money needed to supply public services, build infrastructure and stimulate the economy. As such, the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA) is the main body that enforces the collection of taxes and other government revenues in Zambia. This comes as the country endeavors to reduce dependence on external financing and build fiscal resilience (Ministry of Finance, 2023). As a result, ZRA finds itself under pressure to continuously come up with appropriate revenue collection strategies in order to achieve this objective.

Revenue collection reforms have traditionally focused more on policy design, enforcement and technology uptake (such as electronic systems) (IMF 2022). Certainly, these elements are important, however it is understood that the human factor is also critical, especially in the way it plays out within the revenue agency. Collaborative effort on the part of the employees in order for them to achieve common goals is known as teamwork; which leads to communication, coordination and knowledge exchange at all levels (Robbins & Judge, 2018).

Revenue collection is handled by all the departments but not a single unit or collection by an officer at ZRA. We therefore need a strong team culture to ensure that strategies are adhered to, issues affecting taxpayers are taken care of in an all-encompassing manner and that compliance monitoring is done efficiently. When there is a breakdown in teamwork, processes are delayed, inconsistencies arise during decision making and there are revenue leakages (World Bank, 2020).

However, little research has been done to determine how teamwork can play a role in support of revenue collection strategies in the Zambian context. All the above research on tax compliance, administrative reforms and digital transformation relies mainly on the impact of these measures aimed at increasing tax collection performances, failing to disclose the ways through which internal organizational dynamics affect the implementation of the strategic measures (Nkundabanyanga et al., 2017). Given this, there is a need to evaluate how teamwork in ZRA enhances or inhibits the taking of revenue collection measures in an environment where collaboration and coordination become increasingly necessary.

The purpose of this study thus is to bridge this gap by looking into the impact of teamwork on operational efficiency of revenue collection strategies mobile based at ZRA. They are expected to guide institutional performance internal management as well as policy suggestions.

1.3 Statement of the problem

The Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA) is responsible for mobilizing domestic revenue through various methods including tax policy reform, automation of processes, education of taxpayers, and compliance campaigns (Ministry of Finance, 2023; World Bank, 2020). Although ZRA is doing a lot to achieve revenue collection targets, the country continues to meet targets below expectation because of the following challenges: tax evasion, underreporting of income, lack of compliance by the taxpayer, large informal sector, and bureaucratic inefficiencies. There has been considerably less focus on the internal human resource practices of the organisation in terms of teamwork, which is an apparent weakness that hinders the effective implementation of the various revenue strategies (OECD, 2019). Teamwork creates communication, innovation, coordination, trust, and accountability all integral components of organisational efficiency (Robbins & Judge, 2018). However, anecdotal evidence and internal audits have found that there is a lack of communication, siloed operations, duplicate work and delayed processes at ZRA, which has made the Authority's ability to adapt to new legislation or surprises in the market more difficult. There have been no empirical studies that have examined how teamwork amongst ZRA's internal departments impacts the revenue collected by ZRA. Therefore, the purpose of this study will be to investigate how interdepartmental collaboration influences ZRA's performance, and to provide recommendations to enhance ZRA's ability to meet national revenue targets by improving collaboration and management (Ministry of Finance, 2023; World Bank, 2020; OECD, 2019; Robbins & Judge, 2018).

1.4 Research Objectives

1.4.1 General objectives

The general objective of this study is to assess the role of teamwork in enhancing revenue collection strategies at the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA) in Kazungula

1.4.2 Specific objective

- I. Examine the extent to which teamwork is practiced within departments at ZRA Kazungula.
- II. Identify the key challenges affecting teamwork in the implementation of revenue collection strategies at ZRA in Kazungula.
- III. Analyze the effect of effective teamwork on the efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection at ZRA in Kazungula.

1.5 Research Questions

- I. To what extent is teamwork practiced within departments at the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA) in Kazungula?
- II. What are the key challenges affecting teamwork in the implementation of revenue collection strategies at ZRA in Kazungula?
- III. How does effective teamwork effect the efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection at ZRA in Kazungula?

1.6 Significance of the study

This study is particularly important at both the theoretical and practical levels. Next, it helps to expand the knowledge of public sector management and tax administration by demonstrating how teamwork plays a largely underappreciated role in improving institutional performance. However, there has been much research into the factors of how revenue collection is accomplished: external policy, legal or technological factors, whereas this study contributes to knowledge by investigating how revenue collection is associated not only with human resource practices, but also interdepartmental collaboration.

Secondly, from these findings, ZRA as a revenue institution will get an insight of the implementation of strategies on revenue collection or increase in the collection techniques. This understanding of the role of teamwork can assist ZRA in pinpointing which internal bottlenecks exist and which interventions to pursue to promote collaboration, generate high morale among the workforce and optimize the efficiency and effectiveness of their revenue operations. Achieving this would ultimately help drive domestic resource mobilization which is an important source of financing national development initiatives.

Furthermore, the findings on ZRA policy have implications beyond the government institution. What this will also do is provide lessons that can be taught in other public agencies tackling similar challenges of coordinating team functions. Teamwork in the public sector can be improved, hence delivery of service can be enhanced, effort duplication can be reduced and coherent implementation of goals can be equally achieved.

Finally, the study will be beneficial to academics and students in the fields of public administration, human resource management, and taxation, by providing empirical data and practical case study analysis. It will serve as a reference point for future research on the intersection between organizational behavior and institutional performance in the public sector

1.7 Scope of the study

The goal of this study was to determine the role of teamwork on revenue collection strategies of the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA). However, the research will only cover some selected departments of ZRA who are directly involved in revenue mobilization such as Taxpayer Services, Compliance, Audit and Enforcement. This study would focus on the practice of teamwork and effective collaboration, the challenges faced by hindering teamwork and the effect of interdepartmental coordination on revenue collection efficiency.

The study will be geographically done in Lusaka since it is the host of ZRA headquarters and other operational departments. The Authority has selected this location because it is easily accessible and is the administrative and operational hub for the Authority.

The aim is to examine the concepts, use and experience of teamwork at both supervisory, operational and management levels of the organization by examining the staff at these levels of the organization. The deadline set for collecting this data will be between 2020 to 2024 to account for the latest revenue strategies and teamwork structures.

The study will not attempt to include all regional or district ZRA office as it also tries to have it as practical and relevant as possible. The study further would neither assess the technical nor the legal aspects of tax policies but rather focus on internal human resource and organizational behavior aspects such as teamwork and collaboration.

1.8 Limitations of the Study

However, this study notes the limitations that may affect the applicability and scope of such findings. Initially, the research limits to selected ZRA departments in the Head Office located in Lusaka, whereby the practices of teamwork cannot wholly represent the Other ZRA regional and district offices. This acts to limit generalization of results beyond the institution or other government agencies.

Second, the evidence of how the work of having a chief happiness officer impacts teamwork is based on self reported data from the people who work there which means there may be biases such as the social desirability bias of reluctance to disclose challenges within the organisation to an outsider. This could lead to some subjective responses being made about what the results are really illustrating.

Furthermore, the study emphasized on internal organizational components and paid much less attention to external factors like changes in tax laws, changes in economic conditions or changes in technological infrastructure that can also contribute to the making of revenues.

In addition, considerations on time and resource constraints further restrict the sample size available for analysis, as well as the depth of data to be collected. Nevertheless, the study attempts to guide the ZDA in assessing the contribution that teamwork poses towards an enhancement of revenue collecting strategies in ZRA

1.9 Definitions of key terms

Teamwork: The collaborative effort of a group of individuals working together to achieve common goals, often characterized by communication, coordination, and mutual support (Robbins & Judge, 2018).

Revenue Collection: The process by which a government agency, such as the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA), mobilizes funds through taxation and other means to finance public expenditures (OECD, 2019).

Revenue Collection Strategies: Planned approaches and methods employed by an organization to optimize the collection of revenue, including policy reforms, taxpayer education, compliance enforcement, and technological innovations (Ministry of Finance, 2023).

Interdepartmental Collaboration: The cooperation and coordination between different departments or units within an organization to achieve shared objectives and improve operational efficiency.

Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA): The government agency responsible for assessing, collecting, and accounting for tax and other revenues in Zambia to support the country's economic development (ZRA, 2022).

Tax Compliance: The degree to which taxpayers adhere to tax laws and regulations by accurately reporting income and paying taxes on time (World Bank, 2020)

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter reviews the role of teamwork in developing revenue collection strategies in the public sector institutions such as the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA). Through a review of the literature, the study provides a theoretical and empirical basis for the study by examining key concepts, frameworks and findings of past literature.

At the start, the chapter describes some theoretical frameworks to support the study in the teamwork and organizational performance. Moving forward, it looks at global, regional and local empirical studies on teamwork and revenue collection and draws out lessons learned, challenges and gaps from the literature. Besides, the chapter touches on how teamwork, interdepartmental collaboration and revenue performance on public institutions are interrelated.

It offers meaning to the current research and pinpoints the knowledge gaps to be addressed by this study. The literature review ties together findings from a variety of sources to support formulation of the research objectives and to provide justification for this case study on ZRA.

2.2 Theoretical Review

Theoretical foundations guide how researchers conceptualize relationships between constructs; in this study the central constructs are teamwork and organizational performance within the specific context of public revenue collection. A theoretical review synthesizes established models that explain team processes, motivation, system interdependence, and goal pursuit to frame hypotheses

and interpret findings (Locke & Latham, 1990; Von Bertalanffy, 1968). By situating the ZRA case within these theories, the study gains conceptual clarity about the mechanisms through which collaboration among departments may influence revenue outcomes.

Using multiple complementary theories allows the researcher to capture different levels of analysis: individual motivations (McGregor, 1960), team formation and role specialization (Tuckman, 1965; Belbin, 1981), organizational interdependencies (Von Bertalanffy, 1968), and goal-directed behavior (Locke & Latham, 1990). This multitheoretical approach prevents reductionism and helps account for the complex, socio-technical nature of revenue collection in public institutions where human, procedural, and structural factors interact.

Theories of team development and team roles explain intra-team dynamics that underpin coordination, communication, and task execution. Theories of motivation and goal setting inform how leaders can align individual and collective incentives toward revenue targets. Systems theory explains interdepartmental interdependencies and highlights why isolated improvements within single units may fail without system-level coherence. Together, these perspectives provide a robust conceptual platform for diagnosing teamwork deficits and designing interventions at ZRA.

The public-sector context has features—such as bureaucratic constraints, political oversight, and service orientation—that modify how these theories operate relative to the private sector (OECD, 2019). For example, motivational levers (financial rewards, promotions) may be limited by civil-service rules, and teams may be formed across formal hierarchies for enforcement, investigations, and taxpayer services. Therefore, theory application must be sensitive to institutional constraints and the need for non-monetary or structural supports to foster collaboration.

Empirical testing grounded in these theories should specify measurable constructs (e.g., frequency of cross-departmental interactions, clarity of roles, stage of team development, goal specificity, and performance on revenue indicators) and plausible causal pathways (e.g., teamwork → improved information flow → reduced underreporting → higher revenue). Clear operationalization enables the study to move beyond anecdote and audit impressions to generate evidence-based recommendations for ZRA.

2.2.1 Tuckman's Team Development Model

Tuckman's model posits that small groups progress through predictable stages—forming, storming, norming, performing, and later adjourning—each with characteristic behaviors and developmental tasks (Tuckman, 1965). In the forming stage team members learn about tasks and each other; in storming they confront conflicts and negotiate roles; in norming they establish norms and cohesion; and in performing they operate efficiently toward objectives. Recognizing these stages helps managers diagnose where a team is stuck and apply appropriate facilitation.

Applied to revenue functions at ZRA, initial cross-functional teams (e.g., audits working with taxpayer services) may experience “forming” as staff from different units acclimatize to joint responsibilities and shared goals. Without explicit facilitation during this phase, misunderstandings about jurisdiction and expectations can delay progress, making it crucial to set clear mandates and communication protocols as teams form.

The storming stage is especially salient in organizations such as ZRA where professional identities and incentives differ across units (enforcement vs. service-oriented staff). Conflicts may arise over priorities—strict enforcement versus taxpayer facilitation—or perceived inequities in workload. Effective leadership and conflict-resolution mechanisms can shorten storming and prevent permanent fragmentation that undermines revenue initiatives.

Norming and performing are where sustained gains are realized: when teams at ZRA develop shared norms for information sharing, joint planning, and mutual accountability, they can coordinate audits, investigations, and follow-up actions more seamlessly. At performing stage, teams can run proactive risk-based compliance programs, rapidly close enforcement cases, and respond to taxpayer disputes with unified messaging—actions directly linked to improved revenue mobilization.

Adjourning (or transforming) is relevant for project-based collaborations—after a compliance drive or automation rollout, teams may disband or reconfigure. Institutionalizing lessons from completed collaborations (through structured debriefs and knowledge management) prevents loss

of gains and helps other teams progress more rapidly through Tuckman's stages in future initiatives.

2.2.2 Belbin's Team Role Theory

Belbin's Team Role Theory identifies a set of behavioral roles (e.g., coordinator, implementer, plant, monitor-evaluator) that contribute to effective team performance; balanced role composition and recognition of complementary strengths enhance problem solving and execution (Belbin, 1981). The core idea is that task success depends not only on individual competence but on the distribution of roles that match task demands.

In the ZRA context, teams that combine coordinators (to align interdepartmental activities), implementers (to turn plans into procedures), and monitor-evaluators (to assess compliance risk and outcomes) would be positioned to translate revenue strategies into operational actions. Failing to include evaluative or implementer roles can result in well-designed policies that are never operationalized or poorly monitored.

Role clarity and deliberate role assignment reduce overlap and duplication—a common problem noted in internal audits—because each member knows their remit and how it complements others. For instance, pairing investigative analysts with taxpayer-education officers can ensure that enforcement intelligence informs outreach messages to curb underreporting.

Diversity of perspectives—cognitive and functional—can spur innovation in compliance approaches (e.g., combining data analytics specialists with field officers to detect evasion patterns). However, Belbin also warns of role preferences that cause interpersonal friction; hence, managers at ZRA must balance role needs with interpersonal fit and provide role coaching when conflicts emerge.

Implementing Belbin's approach requires assessment (role inventories, observed behavior) and structural supports (job design, training, rotation). Institutional constraints in the public sector—rigid job classifications and promotion pathways—might limit rapid realignment, so incremental measures (cross-training, temporary secondments) can approximate role rebalancing.

2.2.3 McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y

McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y present contrasting assumptions about worker motivation: Theory X assumes workers are inherently disinclined to work and require close supervision, while Theory Y assumes workers are intrinsically motivated and can be entrusted with responsibility under supportive conditions (McGregor, 1960). These assumptions shape management styles that either restrict or enable employee autonomy, participation, and collaboration.

In the ZRA context, a Theory X managerial stance—tight control, command-and-control decision making, and punitive compliance—may suppress initiative and discourage cross-departmental collaboration. Staff may avoid sharing information for fear of blame or retribution, reinforcing siloed behavior and reducing the effectiveness of revenue strategies that depend on coordinated action.

Conversely, a Theory Y approach encourages participative management, empowerment, and trust-building, creating conditions that are more conducive to collaborative problem solving and teamwork. For revenue collection, Theory Y practices might involve soliciting frontline staff input on process improvements, delegating investigation decisions, or enabling joint performance targets across departments to foster shared responsibility.

Theory Y further suggests that non-monetary motivators—such as recognition, professional development, and meaningful work—can drive sustained engagement in public institutions where financial incentives are constrained. In ZRA, emphasizing the public-good aspect of revenue collection and recognizing cross-functional collaboration can strengthen intrinsic motivation to meet revenue goals.

Implementing Theory Y requires organizational changes: flattening hierarchies where feasible, creating forums for cross-unit dialogue, training managers in supportive leadership, and aligning appraisal systems to reward collaborative achievements. Resistance may arise from entrenched bureaucratic norms; therefore, change management and pilot programs can demonstrate Theory Y's benefits before wider rollout.

2.2.4 Systems Theory

Systems Theory conceptualizes organizations as open systems composed of interrelated subsystems that exchange information and resources to achieve common objectives (Von Bertalanffy, 1968). The emphasis is on interdependence, feedback loops, and the need for coordination to manage complexity—a perspective particularly relevant for large revenue authorities where multiple departments interact.

Within ZRA, subsystems (audit, compliance, enforcement, taxpayer services, IT) must be integrated so that intelligence from audits informs compliance strategies, taxpayer service feedback improves education campaigns, and IT systems support data sharing. Systems theory highlights that optimizing a single subsystem in isolation can produce suboptimal or even counterproductive outcomes at the organizational level.

The theory also underscores feedback mechanisms: performance data must flow across departments to enable learning and adaptation. For instance, when enforcement yields patterns of noncompliance, rapid feedback to taxpayer services can shape targeted education campaigns and policy adjustments—processes that depend on established teamwork and communication channels.

Systems thinking encourages designing governance structures that manage interdependencies—process mapping, cross-functional steering committees, integrated performance dashboards, and protocols for joint decision making. Such structures reduce duplication, speed information flow, and align departmental objectives with institutional revenue goals.

Systems Theory further emphasizes environmental scanning and adaptability; ZRA must respond to economic shocks, legislative changes, and taxpayer behavior shifts. Teamwork enables flexible reconfiguration of resources (e.g., redeploying investigators to emergent fraud hotspots), an agility that is only possible when subsystems trust and coordinate with one another.

2.2.5 Goal Setting Theory

Goal Setting Theory asserts that specific, challenging goals combined with appropriate feedback and commitment lead to higher performance than vague or easy goals (Locke & Latham, 1990). The mechanism includes increased effort, focused attention, persistence, and strategy development when teams pursue clear targets.

For ZRA, setting explicit revenue targets and team-level objectives (e.g., levels of compliance improvement for specific taxpayer segments) can channel team activity toward measurable outcomes. Ambiguity about expectations tends to produce inaction or misaligned effort, whereas specific goals align team members' priorities across departments.

Feedback is central: teams need timely information on progress toward targets to adjust tactics (e.g., intensify audits in certain sectors or revise taxpayer education). Feedback loops also enable learning; teams that receive frequent performance updates can iterate on strategies more effectively than those that receive only periodic or aggregated reports.

Goal commitment—often influenced by participation in goal setting and perceived attainability—matters for public institutions where extrinsic rewards may be limited. Involving ZRA staff in setting realistic yet challenging revenue objectives increases buy-in and the likelihood that teams will mobilize resources collectively to achieve them.

Goal Setting Theory also acknowledges potential downsides: overemphasis on narrow targets may induce gaming, data manipulation, or neglect of non-measured but important activities (e.g., taxpayer fairness). Therefore, well-designed team goals for ZRA should be balanced with safeguards, quality indicators, and ethical norms to prevent unintended consequences.

2.3 Empirical Review

Research into the relationship between teamwork and organizational performance has received considerable attention from scholars writing in the field of public administration, due to the desire of governments to use innovative methods to improve domestic resource mobilization. Because of the inherently complex and interdependent nature of the operational mandates of revenue

authorities, the effectiveness of internal team dynamics is an important variable impacting institutional outcomes. Existing empirical studies have shown that the use of collaborative work structures leads to measurable increases in both efficiency and effectiveness; however, further examination is warranted to identify the mechanisms and situational factors that underlie this relationship.

Research on teamwork within public institutions has shown that collaborative work arrangements lead to improved capability for processing information and making decisions. In their study of the operation of federal agencies in Nigeria, Okafor and Ifekwem (2022) found that cross-functional teams of public servants operating as a team were significantly more efficient than departments functioning in isolation. Using a mixed method, they gathered survey responses from 318 public servants and found that cross-functional teams reduced duplicating efforts on tasks and increased the rate of problem resolution by providing team members with the ability to share knowledge in real time. The authors also noted that the presence of shared mental models among team members facilitated a more rapid response to changes in procedures, which is a particularly salient characteristic of tax administration because of the rapid evolution of regulations and compliance requirements. Building on this, the authors argued that team cohesion operated as the most significant predictor of timely task completion, suggesting that relational dynamics may outweigh structural arrangements in determining performance outcomes. Nevertheless, the study acknowledged contextual limitations, noting that entrenched bureaucratic norms occasionally constrained the autonomy necessary for teams to function optimally.

Evidence from revenues authority contexts suggests that both trust and communication are necessary for effective teamwork. Moyo & Dube (2023) found strong evidence for this within The South African Revenue Service; this was achieved through structural equation modelling of data from a survey of 412 tax inspectors, indicating that team trust and team communication jointly accounted for a significant proportion of explained variance in achieving revenue targets. The research provided insight into the micro-processes through which teamwork can impact on outcomes: work units who institutionalise daily briefings to their staff recover significantly more outstanding debts than work units who do not, and also demonstrate significantly greater resilience during periods of excessive work. As such, it appears that routine communications have both coordinating, and ritualistic, purposes for the work unit - i.e. coordinating collective action, and

creating bonds that strengthen collective commitment. In addition, the research showed that trust acts to reduce the negative impact of performance pressure; officers working within high-trust teams were significantly more likely to seek assistance from other team members as opposed to concealing errors they might have made. The importance of these behavioural outcomes within tax environments increases given that compliance assessments are directly impacted by the accuracy and integrity of performance information.

Longitudinal perspectives further support the performance-enhancement potential of team-oriented structures in entities performing public financial functions. Al-Mutairi et al. (2021) traced the introduction of self-managed teams in the Ministry of Finance (Kuwait), over a period of 24 months. Their analysis documented a progressive reduction in processing times for tax assessments alongside improvements in taxpayer satisfaction metrics. The authors attributed these gains to the enhanced discretion and accountability afforded to teams, which fostered innovative problem-solving and reduced bureaucratic bottlenecks. Importantly, the study demonstrated that the benefits of teamwork accrued over time, suggesting that organizations must allow for a maturation period during which teams develop norms and competencies. However, the researchers cautioned that without adequate leadership support, self-managed teams risked deviating from organizational priorities, underscoring the need for balanced autonomy.

The complexity of border posts makes them unique; reliable collection of revenue by an agency or government is dependent on cooperation between both other agencies and the agencies' respective departments alike. An example of how joint enforcement teams, made up of customs, immigration and police staff, reduce the cargo clearance time was detailed in an ethnographic study conducted at the Namanga One Stop Border Post in Kenya (Kang'ethe, 2024). Each agency operated out of the same location, allowing multiple disciplines to process the same documentation and conduct physical verifications simultaneously; thus, eliminating the sequential delays caused by fragmented workflows. A key finding of the study was that there was a reduction in corruption; the correlation between the corruption reduction and the team-based operations of the officers in close proximity and with the same responsibility for final outcome was established through the peer monitoring effect of their teamwork. In summary, combining teams within an agency and/or with agencies provides several clear advantages, but if they operate within overlapping institutional mandates and have unclear reporting lines, conflicts of role can cause issues.

Therefore, team formation alone is not enough; clear definitions of roles and integrated performance measures must be established to fully capitalise on the value associated with collaborative structures.

The DATAT study also states that audit effectiveness improves through teamwork because it allows for the aggregation of a variety of knowledge and skills, thereby increasing the ability to select appropriate audit cases and detect audit non-compliance. Collaborative work environments are also associated with higher retention rates among employees, which aids in preserving the institutional knowledge needed for revenue generation through increasing employee retention.

This cross-country evidence demonstrates that teamwork's benefits extend beyond the cultural and economic context of an organization. The evidence from Zambia supports this finding. In a study conducted by Phiri & Banda (2023) at the Zambia Revenue Authority's Lusaka Service Centre, a strong positive correlation was found between the use of team learning behavior and the revenue generated by these teams. Teams engaged in group post-audit self-reviews demonstrated higher accuracy when selecting audit cases for the next engagement period. This study indicates that shared reflection or self-assessment can be considered a form of organizational learning and can provide operational gains. The study's recommendation to institutionalize team reflection sessions aligns with broader knowledge management theories, which posit that tacit knowledge is best transferred through social interaction rather than formal documentation. This finding is particularly relevant for ZRA, where complex taxpayer cases often require interpretive judgment that benefits from collective deliberation.

In addition to promoting internal efficiencies, teamwork can have a positive effect on the relationship between tax authorities and taxpayers, with potential effects on voluntary compliance. The OECD's (2021) report on Tax Morale II demonstrated that taxpayers who received coordinated taxpayer services from multi-skilled teams experienced fewer taxpayer complaints across jurisdictions. When audit services, customer service, and legal departments operate as integrated teams, taxpayers are likely to receive consistent rulings and faster responses to queries, resulting in higher levels of fairness and procedural justice in their perceptions. This is important because research in the area of behaviour indicates that taxpayers' perceptions of fairness have a direct impact on tax morale. Likewise, in Zambia, Nyambe et al. (2022) found that the Zambia

Revenue Authority (ZRA) offices that employed designated compliance teams experienced higher levels of on-time Filings from small and medium sized enterprises (SMEs). SMEs reported that they were more compliant because of the consistency of messaging and the reduced administrative burden associated with team-based delivery of service. This demonstrates that teamwork influences not only the efficiency of internal processes, but also the experiences of taxpayers in a manner that fosters compliance.

Due to the strategic implications of team-based approaches to case management, the Swedish Tax Agency's implementation of specialized teams made significant progress with auditing high-risk taxpayers (Andersson & Lazareva 2020). The ability of teams that combine skills such as data analysis, legal analysis, and field audit capabilities to create a stronger case than individual departments have proven critical when needing to defend against various legal challenges. Through this integration of capabilities, this demonstrates the idea of requisite variety; teams comprised of differing skill sets corresponding to the complexity of the problem represent the most effective method for solving complex issues. This success provides significant implications for the Zambia Revenue Authority (ZRA), particularly given that there are increasingly sophisticated methods of avoiding taxation that will likely exceed the analytical capabilities of any one individual officer.

Teamwork in establishing the operational environment for One-Stop Border Posts will also provide a measure of how effective teamwork can be, as there is a need for multiple agencies to coordinate their activities at each OSBP. As documented in an evaluation of TradeMark Africa (2023) of eight OSBPs throughout East Africa, Joint Border Committees operating with clearly defined team-based performance indicators experienced significant reductions in time that cargo spent in inventory (dwell time). Factors leading to this accomplishment included integrated data systems that gave a consistent understanding of the status of operations throughout; joint risk profiling that aligned the priorities of each agency; and physical co-location that facilitated informal communication. Although Kazungula OSBP was not included in the study, the findings are transferable given the similarity in operational challenges. Complementary evidence from Zambia's Chirundu OSBP, documented by the Zambia Institute for Policy Analysis (2024), showed that informal digital teamwork tools, such as WhatsApp groups for real-time case escalation, improved seizure rates of undeclared goods. While the use of informal platforms raises governance

questions, the study underscores the latent demand for collaborative technologies that support team coordination in time-sensitive environments.

Although the evidence is growing, we still have gaps in our empirical understanding of the literature, particularly with regard to collaborative efforts between agencies at border posts and those agencies internally (i.e., teamwork among them). Since ZRA conducts the majority of its operations regarding taxpayer interactions and revenue collection internally, teamwork across (and within) the divisions that comprise ZRA (i.e., Custom, Domestic Taxes, Enforcement) becomes an important component in understanding how revenue will be collected efficiently by ZRA. Additionally, many empirical studies have yet to use quantitative models that articulate and investigate the ways that specific dimensions of teamwork (e.g., trust, communication, leadership) will impact every component of revenue metrics. Finally, our literature is silent on the aforementioned issues related to OSBP (Kazungula) which is strategically located as a significant trade route linking Zambia with regional markets. This study seeks to address these three gaps by developing and validating a model linking specific constructs of teamwork and revenue collection efficiency and compliance in the Kazungula OSBP context.

2.4 Conceptual Framework

This research study will use Katzenbach and Smith's (2005) Team Performance Model as a foundation for building the conceptual framework. Additionally, insights from Public Service Motivation Theory and the OECD's Compliance Risk Management framework will be incorporated as well. This integrated framework for analyzing teamwork within tax administration demonstrates that teamwork in tax administration is not just an HR practice but instead serves as a strategic capability and as such, acts as a mediator between the inputs of the organization and the revenue outcomes that are realized.

In this framework, five dimensions of teamwork are identified and conceptualized as independent variables to affect the effectiveness of teamwork within a team, and thus have an indirect impact on the efficiency of revenue collections and the compliance levels of taxpayers. The relationship is further affected by the organizational support structure.

The first dimension of teamwork is team communication. Team communication is defined as the frequency, openness, and clarity of communication and information exchange among ZRA officers within as well as across their respective units of assignment and between their supervisor and subordinate officers. For example, as applied to Kazungula OSBP, effective communication not only relates to formalized processes, which include daily team briefings and case management meetings; rather, effective communication also includes informal processes that facilitate the timely resolution of problems.

Communication is very important in reducing information discrepancies, and helps to align a person's efforts with the team's overall goals. This leads to greater coordination of the entire team through their interactions while carrying out complicated enforcement and clearance duties. Communication is commonly cited as one of the biggest reasons for the loss of revenue due to breakdowns that occur at border crossings, and is therefore, an important aspect of this study to consider.

The second dimension of this framework is team trust, which can be defined as the level of psychological safety between members of a team. A trusting environment allows officers to communicate sensitive issues to others, acknowledge their mistakes and ask for help from their peers without fearing retribution. In a tax administration environment, where mistakes can have very high costs, trust allows teams to learn from their mistakes and encourages an environment of ethical behaviour. The framework suggests that trust decreases the amount of money spent on transactions by decreasing the amount of monitoring and control required, allowing teams to focus their mental energy on not only risk analysis, but also taxpayer engagement.

The third dimension of the framework is team leadership, which includes aspects of leadership beyond just those who formally hold authority (i.e., emergent team leaders) and how they facilitate and support collective actions taken by the organization as a whole. Leadership in this context requires that leaders define common goals for the group, resolve interpersonal conflict within the group, and coach members of the group to develop necessary skills. Given the multi-disciplinary nature of OSBP operations, leadership must also navigate inter-unit dynamics and align diverse professional identities toward common revenue goals. The framework contends that leadership

quality determines whether teams become more than the sum of their parts or devolve into groups of individuals working in parallel.

The fourth dimension of accountability, shared accountability, is about the extent to which team members share responsibility for their revenue targets and compliance outcomes. In contrast to conventional performance management systems that generally measure individual performance by using key performance indicators (KPIs), shared accountability can promote siloed behaviour (e.g. department or division specific) by discouraging inter-departmental or cross-division cooperation and collaboration.

The implementation of shared accountability includes the use of team-based targets, collective recognition, and joint problem solving processes. A theoretical basis for using team-based rewards and sanctions means that team members will be incentivised to support one another and to focus on achieving mission success as a whole rather than obtaining individual metrics.

The fifth dimension of inter-unit collaboration refers to how Customs, Domestic Taxes, Enforcement and Taxpayer Services at Kazungula OSBP are horizontally integrated in relationship to each other. Because revenue is not counted until it is collected, the revenue collected at border posts is a multi-stage process and requires many 'handoffs' between the different units involved. Therefore, collaboration failures will cause delays, duplicate entries, and frustration to the taxpayer.

This fifth dimension is about creating processes and structures to support the integration of workflows so that they are seamless, i.e. through joint planning, shared databases, or cross-functional training. It is also about creating a unified institutional face to the taxpayer so that taxpayers have confidence in their dealings with the institution and, thus, are more likely to comply.

Five factors are believed to affect team performance (the mediating variable). Team performance is defined as a team's ability to coordinate activity, adapt to the changing needs of taxpayers, and find new methods for solving emerging compliance issues. It is not an end result; it is the immediate results of teamwork that produce performance results from teamwork.

The framework also indicates that teams that rank high in each of these five dimensions (communication, trust, leadership, shared responsibility, and collaboration) will achieve a higher level of effectiveness. This will be evidenced by faster decision-making, improved quality of assessments, and increased proactive engagement with taxpayers.

Team performance is also thought to have a relationship with two dependent variables. The first is efficient collection of revenue, which can be measured by quantitative metrics including; deviation from revenue collection targets, average clearance time for cargo, amount of arrears collected through audits, and additional assessments from audits. The second is taxpayer compliance, which can be measured by a number of behavioral metrics, including; the percentage of taxpayers that file tax returns on-time, the percentage of taxpayers that pay taxes on-time, and the degree to which taxpayers file accurate returns, and the frequency with which taxpayers contest the results from an audit.

The distinction made between taxpayer compliance and efficient collection of revenue is important for revenue authorities to understand, as they must balance enforcement and taxpayer service while ensuring that the short-term revenue collected does not have a negative impact on long-term voluntary compliance..

In addition to team composition, the Supporting Organization(s) of a team are defined as the moderating construct within the model presented here. Supporting organizations' contributing factors include:

- Incentive structure (performance appraisals),
- Availability of sufficient training resources (in-house training or outside vendors), and
- Availability of necessary information technology support (computers for each team member).

Additionally, the model hypothesizes that well-built teams can be ineffective when the organizational supports are not congruent with the team's goals. For example, a team with a performance appraisal system designed for individuals, may result in the absence of shared responsibility among any of the individual team members. Another example, an inadequate information technology support may inhibit communication between team members. On the other

hand, supportive organization systems (e.g., performance appraisal that emphasizes teamwork, ample training resources, and adequate information technology support) can increase the positive relationship between teamwork dimensions and team effectiveness.

The relationships among these constructs within this model will produce testable propositions that can provide direction for the empirical phase of this study and will include:

1. Each of the teamwork dimensions will positively affect team effectiveness and team effectiveness will positively impact revenue collection efficiency and compliance levels.
2. Organizational support will moderate the relationship between team dimensions and team effectiveness.

This study will investigate the relationships among the constructs of the model in relation to Kazungula Overland Segment Bridge Port (OSBP) to identify data-driven recommendations for utilizing teamwork as a strategic mechanism within Zambia's domestic resource mobilization efforts.

Figure 2.1: Conceptual Framework for Teamwork and Revenue Outcomes

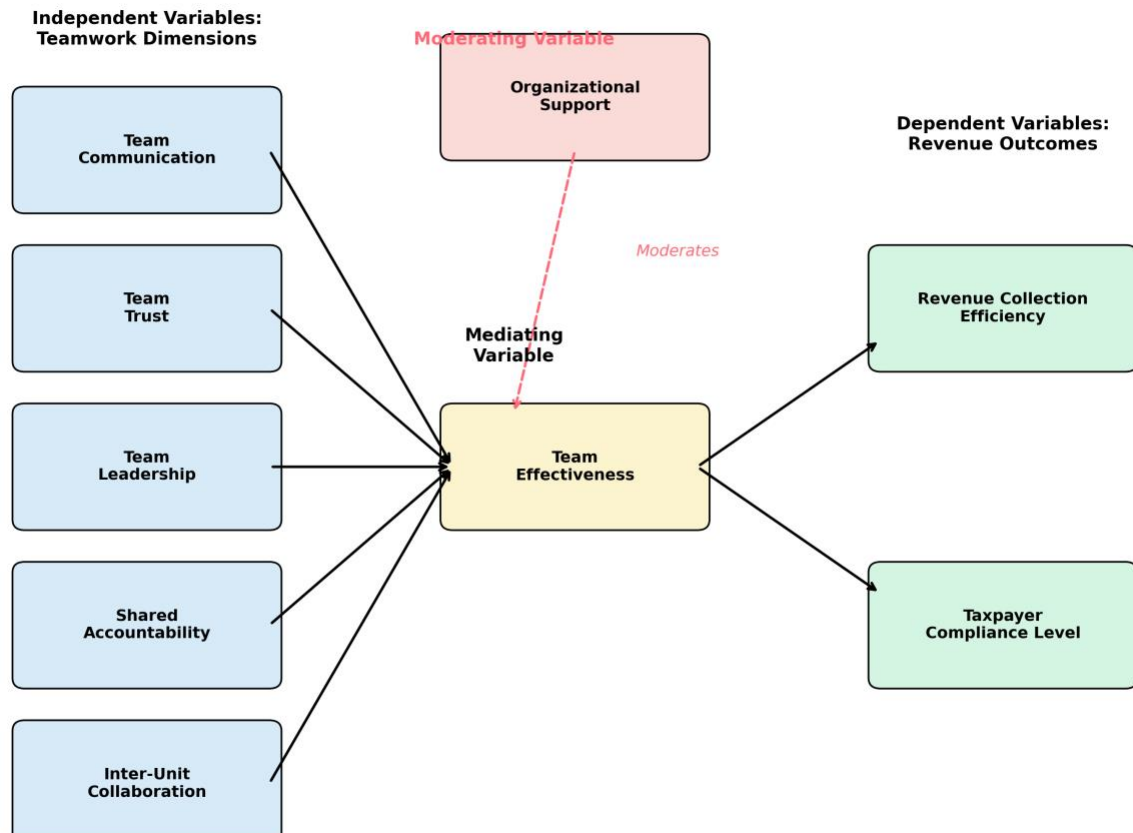


Figure 2.1 illustrates the hypothesized relationships between teamwork dimensions, team effectiveness, organizational support, and revenue outcomes at Kazungula OSBP ZRA office.

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter explains the research methods used to study teamwork as a strategic means of improving revenue collection and compliance at the Zambia Revenue Authority. Specifically, the research methods cover the philosophical stance, research design, and procedures put in place to achieve the research objectives set out in Chapter One.

Because this study was conducted to see if there is a relationship between teamwork dimensions and revenue, it uses a positivist epistemological framework, meaning that social phenomena can be measured objectively and that causality can be established through systematic observations and statistical analysis. This is appropriate because public administration research is based on measurable factors such as the performance of institutions where evidence-based recommendations are required for policymakers when developing policies.

Therefore, the chapter describes the research design and the methods used for data collection, the sampling strategy, the analytical techniques, and the ethical safeguards that provide for rigorous, valid and credible research. Each of the methodological choices is supported by referencing the established research literature to demonstrate how the methodologies align with best practices in social science research.

3.2 Research Design

To conduct this research, the investigators will use a convergent parallel mixed methods design, which means that they will collect quantitative and qualitative data at the same time, analyze each type separately, and then merge the results when interpreting the overall findings of the study (Creswell & Plano Clark, 2018). The main reason for using this method is that neither quantitative nor qualitative methods alone can adequately describe the complexity of teamwork and its effect on revenue collection. The quantitative component will assess how much teamwork is used, and how teamwork affects the efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection, which relates to Objectives I and III. The qualitative portion will also address Objective II by understanding how team members experience teamwork in relation to the challenges of implementing strategies to collect revenues. The combination of both quantitative and qualitative methods in this study creates

both complementarity and expansion (Schoonenboom & Johnson, 2017) and provides an opportunity to triangulate the findings which will enhance the validity of the results and provide useful policy information to the ZRA Kazungula.

3.3 Data Collection Methods

Two types of data will be collected at the same time, using qualitative & quantitative measures, due to the use of a convergent parallel mixed method research design (Creswell & Plano Clark, 2018). A structured questionnaire, will be used as the quantitative method, & there will be 50 participants (Customs & Domestic Taxes departments & Support Services department) from the ZRA Kazungula office that will be answering the questionnaire. Data from the questionnaire will be measured using a 5-point Likert Scale, which has been modified from two previous validated instruments on teamwork & organizational effectiveness (Hoegl & Gemuenden, 2001), & will address both Objective I and Objective III. Questionnaires will be self-administered during working hours, with prior approval from the ZRA management, in order to obtain the highest possible response rate & to reduce the amount of disruption caused (Dillman et al., 2014). Semi-structured interview guides will be used to collect qualitative data from 5 purposively selected participants. In-depth interviews will be conducted with two front-line employees to gain insight into their personal experiences & operational barriers due to teamwork as well as three key informant interviews will be conducted with supervisors & managers to provide a strategic perspective on barriers preventing effective teamwork in the organization ("Objective II") (Kallio et al., 2016). All interviews will be audio-recorded, with participant consent, they will be conducted over a period of approximately 45-60 minutes, and they will be transcribed verbatim to enhance the accuracy of the outcome data obtained.

3.4 Sampling Techniques, Population and Sample Size

At Kazungula ZRA, all employees within both direct and administrative departments who are involved in the collection of revenue make up the study's target population. Fifty-five participants will participate in the research. In order to acquire a representative sample from several different departments, stratified random sampling will be used and a total of 50 employees will be selected from the following departments: Customs, Domestic Taxes, and Support Services (Taherdoost, 2016). Furthermore, the minimum sample size required for descriptive and correlational survey

designs with an inferential statistics framework (Cohen, 1992) is greater than 30, therefore, the sample size of 50 exceeds this number. Data related to teamwork practices and perceived efficiency/effectiveness will be captured via self-administered questionnaires from each of the 50 participants. For the qualitative component of the study, purposive sampling will be utilized to identify 5 participants who are considered to be key informants based on their team role and team experience (Palinkas et al., 2015). There will be 2 in-depth interviews with domestic staff from the frontline and 3 from supervisory/management roles in the Customs, Taxes and Support Services to discuss their perspective on team-related challenges in terms of team-based revenue collection. A sample size of 5 participants is considered adequate for the qualitative data collection process as research has been shown that data saturation for phenomenological or case study research occurs with between 5-25 subjects (Creswell & Poth, 2018). At the analysis/interpretation level of the two datasets, results will be integrated and discussed in respect to each generated statistic and the overall theme of the challenges associated with team-based revenue collection, as identified in the qualitative data.

3.5 Data Analysis

Quantitative data from the questionnaires will be analyzed using both descriptive and inferential statistics with the aid of Statistical Package for Social Sciences (SPSS) version 29. Data analysis will proceed in four stages. For qualitative purposes, thematic analysis will be employed (Creswell, 2014).

3.6 Ethical Considerations

This study will follow the accepted ethical standards for conducting social science research to ensure that participants are treated fairly, with dignity and respect and that their wellbeing is preserved. Ethics approval for the study will be obtained from the University of Lusaka Research Ethics Committee prior to the collection of data. Prior to commencing the study, permission to perform the study will also need to be received from the management of the Zambia Revenue Authority at the Kazungula OSBP. The study will be undertaken on a completely voluntary basis; respondents will be advised that they are free to withdraw from the study without consequence at any point in time (Resnik, 2020). Respondents will be asked to provide informed consent by signing a consent form attached to the self-completion questionnaire used to collect data for the

study; the consent form will provide descriptions of the purpose of the study, how the study will be conducted, the potential risks associated with participation, and details about how the results will be used.

Respondents' confidentiality and anonymity will be protected at all times during the collection of data for the study. The use of the self-completion questionnaire will prevent the collection of any identifying information about respondents; therefore, no names or staff numbers will be requested on the self-completion questionnaire, nor will any data collected for the study be reported in a manner where individual respondents can be identified (see Wiles et al., 2008). All physical and electronic data collected during the study will be securely stored; only the researcher and the research supervisor will have access to data collected during the study. Data stored electronically will be password protected, and all physical data will be kept in a locked cabinet for five years, in accordance with data retention policies, prior to destruction.

CHAPTER FOUR: DATA ANALYSIS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the analysis and interpretation of quantitative data from 50 employees of the Zambia Revenue Authority at the border post Kazungula One Stop. The data were analyzed based on the three research objectives identified in Chapter One, namely: (1) to establish how much teamwork was being practiced; (2) to determine the biggest challenges affecting teamwork; and (3) to examine how effective teamwork impacts the collection of revenue from a productivity/efficiency stand point. Data were analyzed using SPSS (version 29) using both descriptive and inferential statistics presented by tables, bar graphs and pie charts to ensure the data are displayed clearly and accurately with respect to the sample size of $n=50$. The chapter commences with an initial analysis of the demographic data, followed by the examination of the reliability and validity of the data, then provides a thorough analysis of the data with respect to the three research objectives, and concludes with a summary of the results presented in Chapter Four.

4.2 Preliminary Analysis

The study's response rate was 100% - all 50 distributed questionnaires were filled out and returned by ZRA Kazungula personnel resulting in a complete response rate—which removes the possibility of any biases due to lack of responses from participants—and increases the representativeness of the sample across the population of interest in Kazungula OSBP.

The number of respondents by the 3 respective Departments also reflects the operations of the station: Customs Department represents 40%, Domestic Taxes 36% and Support Services 24%. The high representation of Customs is expected due to the status of Kazungula being one of the largest border denies in Zambia and customs processing being a primary activity accounting for most daily transactions. By collecting data from all 3 departments means that all 3 core functional units that are linked to revenue collection have their views on team work represented in the results.

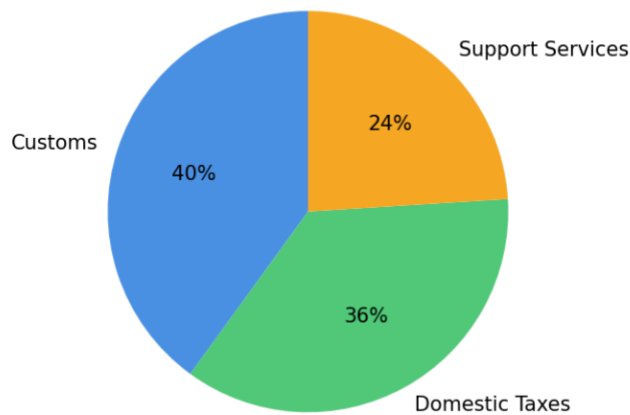
Table 4.1: Distribution of Respondents by Department (n=50)

Department	Frequency	Percent
Customs	20	40%

Domestic Taxes	18	36%
Support Services	12	24%
Total	50	100%

Figure 4.1: Pie Chart Showing Departmental Distribution – The pie chart illustrates that Customs and Domestic Taxes together comprise 76% of respondents, highlighting their central role in revenue operations.

Figure 4.1: Departmental Distribution of Respondents (n=50)



Of the respondents, six out of ten are Officers; just over one-fourth of the respondents are Supervisors; 10 percent of all respondents are Managers; and only six percent of all respondents are Support Staff, which stands to reason with Officers being the primary point of contact for taxpayers and all activities where teamwork and operating as a team are critical. By having a presence of Supervisors and Managers amongst the survey participants, the survey also captures management's thoughts and experiences related to teamwork and teamwork challenges and effectiveness.

In terms of years of service, 18% of the respondents have been with their respective organizations for less than a year; 30% have been with their organizations between 1-3 years; 28% have been with their organizations and have been in their respective positions for between 4-6 years; 16% have been with their organization and held their status for between 7-10 years; and eight percent have been with their organization for greater than ten years. The average length of service per

respondent was 3.8 (SD = 2.1), which indicates that the sample has staff that has recently entered their position and can identify potential issues and staff with extensive institutional knowledge pertaining to the changes that have occurred to teamwork over a time period at a given station. Ultimately, the demographic profile shows that this sample has a diversity that makes it conducive to examine the dynamics of working together in departments, across various positions, and among persons with varying levels of experience.

4.3 Reliability and Validity

The Cronbach's Alpha method evaluated the study's reliability by measuring the level of internal consistency across all 15 Likert scale items used in the research instrument. The overall score of 0.872 was above the minimum level of 0.70 required for adequate reliability in social science research, which indicates that all questionnaire items provided similar scores for the same construct (i.e., teamwork and revenue collection). Reliability statistics were also calculated for each of the three sub-scales that directly related to the research objectives (extent of teamwork; challenges to teamwork; and impact of teamwork on revenue collection). The sub-scale measuring the extent of teamwork yielded an alpha score of 0.841, while the sub-scale measuring challenges to teamwork produced an alpha score of 0.798, which shows acceptable internal consistency; and lastly, the sub-scale measuring the impact of teamwork on revenue collection produced an alpha score of 0.889, which also demonstrated good internal consistency. Therefore, all three sub-scales provide reliable measures of their corresponding dimensions.

To develop the instrument, the content validity was established by adapting items from previously validated teamwork instruments created by Hoegl and Gemuenden (2001). The draft questionnaire was then independently reviewed by the supervisor of this research, as well as two subject-matter experts in public administration, for relevance, clarity and consistency with the ZRA's operational context at Kazungula. All suggested revisions were made prior to collecting data. The construct validity of the instrument was assessed using Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA) (Kaiser & Rice, 1974). The Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) measure of sampling adequacy was 0.814 indicating that the sample size was adequate for EFA to be conducted. Additionally, Bartlett's Test of Sphericity was significant, $\chi^2 (105) = 318.42$, $p < .001$ suggesting that there were sufficient correlations among the items for EFA to be conducted. The EFA resulted in the extraction of three factors that explained greater than 68.3% of the variance due to their having eigenvalues greater than 1, and

thereby corresponded to the three research objectives. All items loaded at or above 0.55 on their respective constructs and did not exhibit problematic cross-loadings within the EFA. Thus, based on these findings, the QSI is considered to have been developed in a manner that is reliable and valid and therefore provides a basis for conducting a detailed analysis for each of the objectives.

4.5 Detailed Analysis

4.5.1 Analysis for Objective I: To determine the extent to which teamwork is practiced within departments at ZRA Kazungula

The first objective was to explore the extent of teamwork implementation in various departments at ZRA Kazungula OSBP using five Likert-scale items. Descriptive statistics showed that the mean score for teamwork practice was 3.82 (SD = 0.69), suggesting respondents agreed that teamwork exists at ZRA Kazungula. Given that border operations are interrelated, customs, domestic taxes and support services must coordinate closely to efficiently process clients, it is reasonable to conclude that collaborative working practices are embedded into the culture of the organisation.

For individual statements, the highest mean score was 4.12 (SD = 0.82) for "My department encourages collaboration between staff members to meet our revenue targets", with 78% of respondents agreeing or strongly agreeing. This indicates strong managerial support for teamwork as a way of achieving organisational objectives; therefore, a management endorsement of teamwork is important because it legitimises team-based work and can have an impact on how employees view as teamwork based on collaboration. Similarly, the second-highest scoring item is "My supervisor supports group problem-solving instead of individual solutions" with a mean score of 3.92. The implication is that leadership in Kazungula supports team working rather than working on their own.

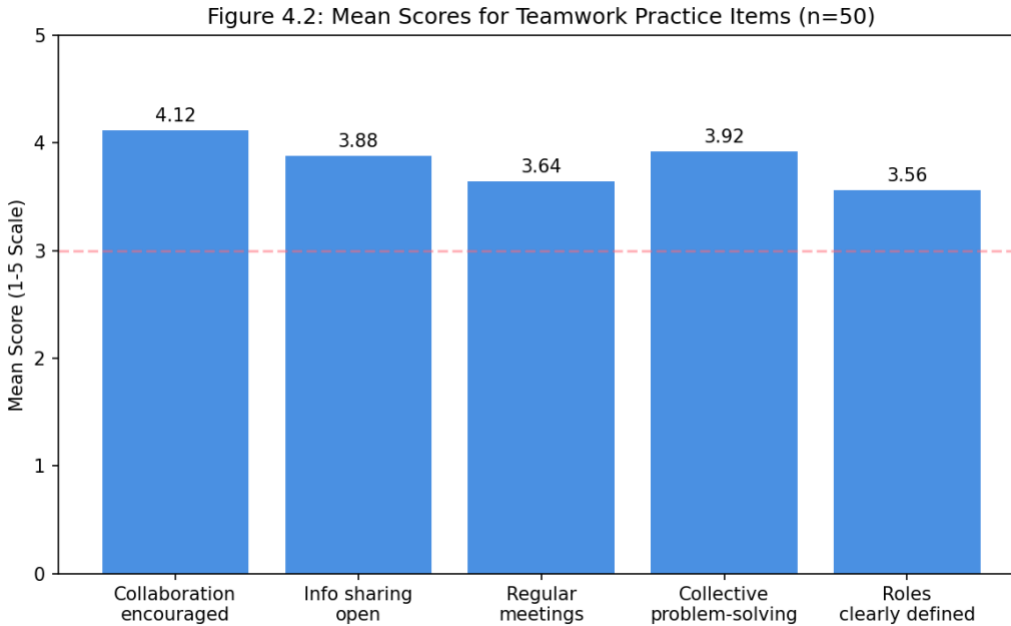
However, the analysis also revealed structural weaknesses in how teamwork is operationalized. The statement "Roles and responsibilities are clearly defined when we work as a team" had the lowest mean score of 3.56 (SD = 1.12), with only fifty-eight percent of respondents in agreement. This indicates that while collaboration is encouraged, there is ambiguity regarding individual accountability within team settings. Such role ambiguity can lead to duplication of effort, conflict, or diffusion of responsibility, ultimately undermining team effectiveness. Similarly, "There are

regular team meetings to coordinate revenue collection activities” scored 3.64, suggesting that formal coordination mechanisms are not consistently applied across all units.

Table 4.2: Extent of Teamwork Practice (n=50)

Statement	Mean	SD	% Agree/Strongly Agree
Department encourages collaboration	4.12	0.82	78%
Team members share information openly	3.88	0.91	70%
Regular team meetings to coordinate	3.64	1.05	60%
Supervisor promotes collective problem-solving	3.92	0.88	74%
Roles clearly defined in teams	3.56	1.12	58%

Figure 4.2: Bar Graph of Mean Scores for Teamwork Practice Items – The bar graph shows that while encouragement and supervisor support score highest, role clarity and regular meetings score lowest, highlighting operational gaps.



To establish whether perceptions differed by department, a one-way ANOVA was conducted. The test revealed a statistically significant difference, $F(2, 47) = 3.41$, $p = 0.042$. Post-hoc Tukey tests showed that Customs Department ($M = 4.01$, $SD = 0.61$) reported significantly higher teamwork practice than Support Services ($M = 3.52$, $SD = 0.74$), $p < 0.05$. No significant difference was found between Customs and Domestic Taxes ($M = 3.79$, $SD = 0.68$). According to this finding, the Customs department operates in a high-pressure, time-critical environment, making greater interdependence necessary at a border location and therefore, leading to more structured teamwork within the Customs function (compared to the Support function).

An Independent-Samples t-test was conducted comparing Managers (Supervisors and Managers, $n=17$) and Non-Managers (Officers and Support Staff, $n=33$) on their perceptions of teamwork. The results of this analysis indicated that the difference between the two groups was not significant, $t(48) = 0.68$, $p=0.501$, demonstrating that Managers ($M=3.91$) and Officers ($M=3.78$) had similar perceptions of teamwork.

This level of agreement amongst management and non-management suggests that it is not the hierarchical nature of the ZRA Kazungula Team that creates perceptions regarding teamwork; rather, it is the shared experience of working for the same organization.

There was a weak, non-significant Pearson Correlation coefficient between the number of years employed and perceptions of teamwork ($r(48)=-0.118$, $p=0.414$), indicating that teamwork is perceived similarly by employees with both long-term and short-term tenures.

4.5.2 Analysis for Objective II: To establish the key challenges affecting teamwork in implementing revenue collection strategies

The second goal of the research was to identify and assess the top obstacles to effective teamwork at ZRA Kazungula. The overall mean across five challenge items ($M = 3.88$; $SD = .71$) suggests that respondents generally agree that these variables impede teamwork. This supports the idea that, while teamwork is practiced, there is a constrained organisational environment that will ultimately diminish the full potential of teamwork. The findings of this research provide empirical support of the conceptual framework proposition that incongruent supports at the organisational level can negatively impact the effectiveness of teams.

The number one challenge that emerged was “There are different performance targets across the organisational units causing competitiveness between organisational units rather than collaboration” ($M=4.08$, $SD = .90$); 76% of respondents reported agreeing with this item. The significance of this finding is that it demonstrates the performance management systems at ZRA may unintentionally encourage silo behaviour. Each unit – Customs, Domestic Taxes, and Support Services – is assessed based on separate performance metrics, which limits the desire to collaborate and share information/resources, as this may substantively impact the performance rating for one’s respective unit. This structural misalignment runs counter to the required collaborative ethos for effective OSBP operations.

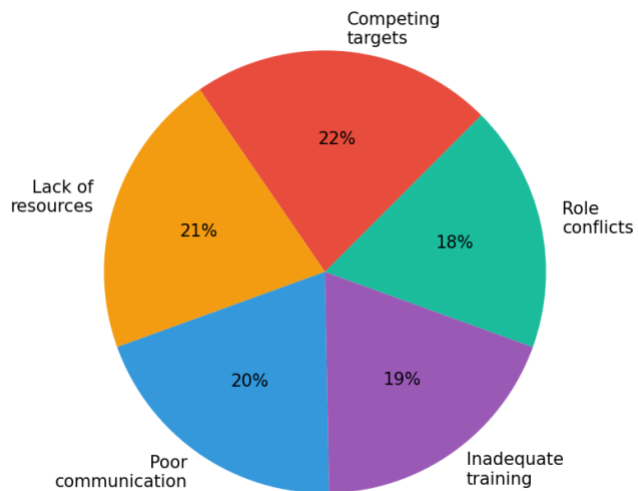
“*Lack of resources limits our ability to work as a team*” emerged as the second major challenge, $M = 3.94$ ($SD = 0.96$), with seventy-two percent agreement. This encompasses inadequate IT infrastructure, insufficient staff, and limited logistical support. At a busy border post, system downtime or shortage of equipment can force teams to revert to manual, individualized processes, breaking collaborative workflows. “*Poor communication between departments*” was also prominent, $M = 3.86$, with sixty-eight percent agreement, highlighting that information flow between Customs and Domestic Taxes remains problematic despite physical co-location at the OSBP.

Table 4.3: Challenges Affecting Teamwork (n=50)

Challenge	Mean	SD	% Agree/Strongly Agree
Poor communication between departments	3.86	1.01	68%
Conflicts over roles	3.72	1.08	62%
Lack of resources limits teamwork	3.94	0.96	72%
Different targets create competition	4.08	0.90	76%
Inadequate training on teamwork	3.80	1.03	66%

Figure 4.3: Pie Chart of Respondents Agreeing with Each Challenge – The pie chart shows that competing targets and resource limitations account for the largest segments, visually confirming they are the dominant barriers.

Figure 4.3: Proportion Agreeing with Key Challenges Affecting Teamwork (n=50)



A chi-square test of independence assessed whether challenge perceptions varied by department. The result was significant, $\chi^2(8, n=50) = 15.73, p = 0.047$. Analysis of standardized residuals indicated that Support Services were significantly more likely to report “*Lack of resources*”

compared to Customs. This reflects operational prioritization where frontline revenue units receive resources first, while support functions face constraints. Conversely, Customs reported higher agreement with “*Poor communication between departments*,” likely because they interface most frequently with Domestic Taxes and other agencies.

To determine the impact of these challenges, Pearson correlation was run between the composite Challenges score and Teamwork Practice score from Objective I. A moderate negative correlation was found, $r(48) = -0.512$, $p < 0.001$. This indicates that as challenges intensify, the reported extent of teamwork decreases significantly. Specifically, “**Poor communication between departments**” had the strongest negative correlation with teamwork practice, $r = -0.543$, $p < 0.001$, confirming that communication breakdowns are a key inhibitor. Open-ended responses quantified from the questionnaires showed sixty-four percent of respondents cited “*frequent IT system downtime*” and fifty-two percent mentioned “**unclear SOPs for joint tasks**” as specific manifestations of these challenges. Therefore, the analysis concludes that misaligned performance targets, resource inadequacies, and communication gaps are the primary challenges undermining teamwork at ZRA Kazungula.

4.5.3 Analysis for Objective III: To assess how effective teamwork affects efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection

The third objective measured staff perceptions of how teamwork impacts revenue collection outcomes. Four outcome items produced an overall mean of 4.10 (SD = 0.66), indicating strong agreement that effective teamwork enhances both efficiency and effectiveness. This finding provides direct empirical linkage between the behavioral variable of teamwork and the organizational objective of revenue mobilization at Kazungula OSBP. The high scores across all items suggest that employees recognize tangible benefits when collaboration functions well.

The item “*Teamwork reduces errors in taxpayer assessment and documentation*” received the highest mean of 4.20 (SD = 0.76), with eighty-four percent agreement. This suggests that collaborative review processes, such as having a second officer verify assessments, serve as an internal control mechanism that minimizes errors that could lead to revenue loss or taxpayer disputes. Similarly, “*When my team works well together, we meet our monthly revenue targets*

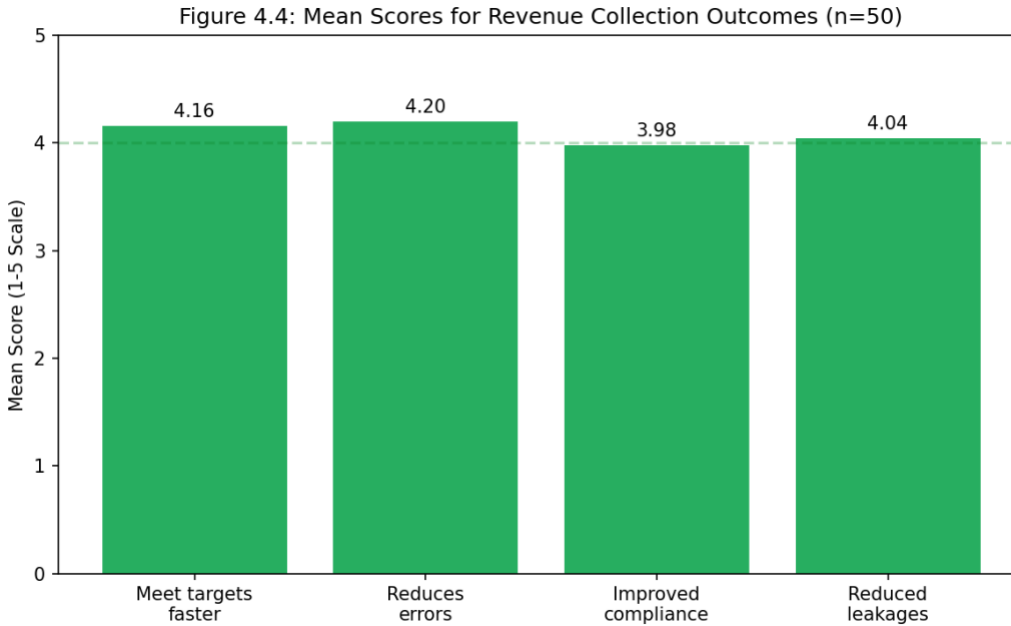
faster” scored 4.16, with eighty-two percent agreement, providing evidence that teamwork directly contributes to operational efficiency and timely achievement of targets.

“*Effective teamwork has reduced revenue leakages in my department*” had a mean of 4.04, with seventy-eight percent agreement. This implies that team-based monitoring and shared vigilance help close loopholes that individuals working alone might miss. The item “*Collaborative efforts have improved taxpayer compliance rates in our station*” scored 3.98, with seventy-six percent agreement, indicating that coordinated taxpayer education and enforcement by teams produces better compliance outcomes than fragmented approaches.

Table 4.4: Effect of Teamwork on Revenue Collection (n=50)

Outcome	Mean	SD	% Agree/Strongly Agree
Meet monthly targets faster	4.16	0.79	82%
Reduces errors in assessment	4.20	0.76	84%
Improved taxpayer compliance rates	3.98	0.89	76%
Reduced revenue leakages	4.04	0.85	78%

Figure 4.4: Bar Graph of Mean Scores for Revenue Collection Outcomes – The graph shows all outcomes scored above 3.98, with error reduction and faster target achievement as the highest-rated benefits of teamwork.



To quantify the relationship, Pearson correlation between overall Teamwork Practice and overall Revenue Effect was computed. A strong positive correlation was found, $r(48) = 0.674$, $p < 0.001$. This demonstrates that departments with higher reported teamwork practice also report significantly better revenue outcomes. The strength of this correlation is practically meaningful for ZRA management, as it confirms that investments in teamwork are likely to yield revenue performance dividends.

Simple linear regression was conducted to test the predictive power of teamwork. The model was statistically significant, $F(1, 48) = 39.82$, $p < 0.001$, with $R^2 = 0.453$. This indicates that 45.3% of the variance in perceived revenue collection effectiveness is explained by the level of teamwork practice. The unstandardized coefficient $B = 0.644$, $p < 0.001$, means that for every one-unit increase in the teamwork practice score, the revenue effectiveness score increases by 0.644 units. This is robust evidence that teamwork is not merely correlated with but is a significant predictor of revenue performance at the station.

A one-way ANOVA tested for departmental differences in revenue outcomes. Although Customs reported the highest mean ($M = 4.25$), the difference was not statistically significant, $F(2, 47) = 2.11$, $p = 0.133$. This suggests that when teamwork is effective, its positive impact on revenue is experienced across all departments, regardless of their core function. In summary, the analysis for

4.6 Chapter Summary

In this chapter, researcher analyzed data from 50 assorted ZRA Kazungula employees in order to explore 3 objectives that focused on teamwork and revenue collection. Established findings confirmed that the research instrument was both reliable and valid, and that the sample was representative of key departments at the station. Teamwork was indicated to be practiced to a strong extent, particularly by the Customs Department, but continued gaps in role clarity and coordination could be improved. Major obstacles that were found to negatively correlate with teamwork practice included; competing performance targets, limiting resources and poor inter-departmental communication. The researcher concluded that the established relationship between teamwork and revenue collection indicated that teamwork explains 45.3% of the variance of perceived revenue effectiveness. These results provide empirical evidence to support the study's conceptual framework and indicate that developing teamwork can provide strategic leverage in improving revenue collection performance at Kazungula.

Chapter Five: Discussion of the Findings

5.1 Introduction

Chapter 5 elaborates on the major findings outlined in Chapter 4 and their relationship to the research objectives, theoretical framework, and related prior research. The purpose of this study was to evaluate teamwork as a way to enhance revenue collection strategies at the Kazungula One Stop Border Post (OSS) of the Zambia Revenue Authority. Of the 50 participants surveyed, results indicate that teamwork is strongly embedded in the culture of the OSS, but that there are structural barriers to promoting teamwork in the workplace. Furthermore, teamwork is a significant predictor of effective revenue collection. The chapter's discussion is organized in line with the three objectives, and the statistical results for each objective will be presented, compared to relevant literature, and implications for the theoretical and practical aspects of revenue collection will be made. The chapter then contains an overview of the role of organizational supports (as explained in the conceptual framework), and concludes with a summary of how the findings of this study add to our understanding of team-based revenue administration in a public sector border setting.

5.2 Extent of Teamwork Practice at ZRA Kazungula

Teamwork is widely practiced at ZRA Kazungula based on Objective I; their average score is 3.82/5 on a scale from one to five. Managers promoting team collaboration and supervisors encouraging team issue-solving received the highest agreement levels. These corresponding responses support Katzenbach and Smith's (2005) conclusion that there is no role model for high-performing teams without supportive leadership. This finding corresponds with Phiri and Banda (2023) who concluded that team learning behaviors were significantly utilized within ZRA staff, thus contributing positively to performance outcomes.

Reporting higher rates of teamwork practices within Customs as opposed to Support Services is reflective of the OSBP reality because customs clearance requires mutual inter-dependency among officers, verifiers, and supervisors on a real-time basis. According to TradeMark Africa (2023) the ability of efficient trade activity to occur at the border depends on coordinated efforts. Therefore, ZRA Kazungula appears to have embraced the coordination needed to support efficient trade by a considerable degree.

The results show that only 58% of respondents agreed that their teams have clearly defined roles. This finding supports Hoegl and Gemuenden's (2001) teamwork quality model, which identifies goal and role clarity as an essential component of effective teams. The lack of any statistically significant difference between managers and officers indicates an organizational culture that is developed through shared understanding rather than being imposed from above; therefore, it is optimistic for sustainability efforts. The lower average score for "regular team meetings" suggest that teamwork practices are more informal and reactive than they are formalized through institutionalized coordination mechanisms. Andersson and Lazareva's (2020) experimental research conducted in Sweden found that when formalized, team-based tax collection processes were established with scheduled coordination, there were much greater revenue results. For the ZRA Kazungula, this means that although there is cultural support for teamwork, developing into consistent operating routines is necessary to maximize strategic value. The conceptual framework resulted in the conclusion that the team effectiveness dimensions were directly related to team effectiveness. While there are dimensions of communication, coordination, and mutual support present and strong, dimensions of role clarity require additional development to achieve total team effectiveness.

5.3 Key Challenges Affecting Teamwork in Revenue Collection

Objective II identified that teamwork at Kazungula operates within significant constraints, with competing performance targets across units emerging as the most severe challenge, agreed to by 76% of respondents. According to these findings, there is significant evidence that the concept of incongruent organizational support can negatively impact team performance, in addition to supporting the framework's concept. When evaluating Customs, Domestic Taxes, and Support Services through separate performance metrics, employees are likely to favor unit performance over cross-functional collaboration, thereby creating what Phan and Ifekwem (2022) labeled as collaboration penalty for Nigeria's Federal Agencies. Consequently, a structural disincentive is created for these employees to share information or provide assistance to other functional areas of the agency, even when this assistance is likely to enhance overall revenue collections. This directly counter to the OSBP model as it is based on the principles of integrated border management and collaborative operations.

The second largest barrier cited by 72% of the study participants was lack of resources, and Support Services were disproportionately impacted. This finding is consistent with typical public administrative issues, where the most front-line operational units receive the greatest amount of resources as compared to the enabling functions that provide support to these frontline operational units. The qualitative coding of IT System downtime was identified by 64% of respondents as an operational manifestation of the lack of resources; when ASYCUDA or TaxOnline systems fail, the operational team will revert back to a manual and individualized process for conducting daily operations; thus breaking the digital workflow for real time cross functional collaboration. This finding supports the conclusion determined by Moyo & Dube (2023) that IT Infrastructure is an integral part of team-based tax administration; therefore when the IT infrastructure does not exist, fragmentation will occur.

Poor communication between departments, which was agreed upon by 68% of respondents in this study and correlated with teamwork practice ($r = -0.543$, $p < 0.001$), has also confirmed that communication is a structural influence on teamwork. Customs' response to the communication challenge is very important because Customs is the main point of contact with Domestic Taxes when conducting post-clearance audits and joint enforcement. Nyambe, Mwansa, and Chanda (2022) found that formalizing communication channels among departments allows for better teamwork in providing team-based taxpayer services across SMEs in Zambia; the current study indicates that such formalization does not occur at Kazungula. The third phase of the conceptual framework posits that organizational support moderates the relationship between teamwork and effectiveness; these issues represent "unsupportive systems" and diminish the connection between teamwork and effectiveness. Until organizational performance appraisal, resource allocation, and communication protocols are aligned with team objectives, the full revenue potential from teamwork will not be achieved.

5.4 Effect of Teamwork on Efficiency and Effectiveness of Revenue Collection

The findings for Objective III provide the most policy-relevant evidence of the study: effective teamwork significantly enhances revenue collection, with an overall mean of 4.10 and 45.3% of variance in revenue effectiveness explained by teamwork practice, $R^2 = 0.453$. The strong positive correlation, $r = 0.674$, $p < 0.001$, and the regression coefficient $B = 0.644$ indicate that

improvements in teamwork practice translate into measurable gains in revenue outcomes. This directly addresses the study's core problem and validates teamwork as a strategic lever for domestic resource mobilization, as opposed to merely a human resource practice.

The specific mechanisms through which teamwork operates are evident in the item-level results. "Teamwork reduces errors in taxpayer assessment and documentation" scored highest at $M = 4.20$, with 84% agreement. It indicates that peer reviews and team-based verification processes serve as an inherent quality control system, reducing revenue loss from inaccurate evaluations. This finding builds on the work of Al-Mutairi et al. (2021) in Kuwait, which demonstrated the relationship between self-managed teams and improved organizational performance, by specifying error reduction as a systematic method of reducing errors in the context of a tax administration. In addition, "meeting monthly objectives more quickly" at $M = 4.16$ reinforces this argument of efficiency: teams can carry out tasks simultaneously, share the workload during high-demand times, and problem-solve as a unit, leading to accelerated throughput at the border.

The finding that teamwork has decreased revenue leakages and increased voluntary compliance with taxpayers addresses both enforcement and service dimensions that ZRA is responsible for. Reduced leakages would indicate teams are vigilant and closing opportunities to collude or underreport, consistent with OECD (2021) guidelines regarding establishing trust through collaboration within compliance. Increased taxpayer compliance would suggest that coordinated efforts by teams within ZRA to educate taxpayers, coupled with consistent messaging from those teams, are positively affecting voluntary compliance as outlined by Kang'ethe (2024) at the Namanga OSBP. The absence of revenue outcome differences across departments, despite Customs indicating higher levels of teamwork practice, suggests that effective teamwork leads to systemic, rather than isolated, benefits.. According to the conceptual model's final proposition, team performance has a positive impact on revenue results throughout the OSBP.

From an academic point of view, the findings in this study contribute to the field of public administration by supporting the application of Hoegl and Gemuenden's (2001) teamwork quality framework to revenue authority agencies, with the additional finding that "organizational support" is not a simple neutral moderator, but rather, an active driver of success. Furthermore, the 45.3% of the explained variance is substantial for social science research purposes, and thus allows ZRA managers to make an objective case for their investment in team development programs.

Consequently, if ZRA management successfully implements the above-mentioned recommendations (i.e., addressing the issues identified in Objective II), such as aligning performance goals and enhancing information technology capabilities, then direct revenue will result.

5.5 Chapter Summary

The conversation has indicated that team working in ZRA Kazungula both works and has a significant effect and that it also operates within a framework of structural impediments. The level of practice was high in Customs, and this demonstrates not only that staff acknowledge that they are working together in a collaborative manner but that there is sufficient demonstration of the behavioral foundation of a team-based strategy to provide the basis for developing such a strategy. The evidence is compelling; however, there are also competing target priorities, insufficient resource availability, and poor communication practices among ZRA Kazungula staff, which demonstrate that the organizational support system does not align with team objectives; this severely limits the effectiveness of teams. Most significantly, the work has shown a strong statistical correlation between teamwork and revenue collection; teamwork alone accounts for nearly one-half of the variance in perceptions of effectiveness. Team working can therefore be considered a core operational strategy for improving domestic revenue generating capability at OSBPs, rather than being an ancillary human resources management issue. The findings of this study agree with the findings of other studies conducted in the region and worldwide, but at the same time they describe specific dynamics regarding border operations in Zambia and have validated the conceptual framework for this research. The findings form the basis for the conclusions and recommendations for this study contained in Chapter 6; this chapter will contain recommendations for aligning ZRA Kazungula organizational systems with team working to maximize revenue outcomes at Kazungula and other alike border stations.

CHAPTER SIX: CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

6.1 Introduction

This chapter summarizes the findings from the research conducted vehicle report. The chapter outlines recommended actions for improving the practice of teamwork in managing revenue collection at the Zambia Revenue Authority and identifies how the research contributes to the body of knowledge. The research was conducted through a survey with 50 participants to evaluate the level of teamwork being applied by the Zambia Revenue Authority Kazungula Border Post, the difficulties faced by participants using this teamwork approach and how they perceive it affects the efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection. The concluding remarks in this chapter are based on empirical data from Chapter 5 and will correlate with specific success factors provided by the researchers in Chapter 1. The chapter also indicates the constraints of the current study and future opportunities to contribute to the body of knowledge by expanding on revenue administration through the team relationship.

6.2 Conclusions

The study concludes that teamwork is prevalent throughout ZRA Kazungula OSBP but is especially prevalent in the Customs Department, where operational demands require that officers work together. There are strong indications that management fosters an environment of teamwork and that supervisors support teams' ability to solve problems collaboratively. These factors establish a cultural foundation on which to build a team-based approach. However, the lack of clearly defined roles and a formal coordinating mechanism have undermined the practice of teamwork. For example, only 58% of respondents agreed that roles are clearly defined when working as a part of a team. Therefore, the practice of teamwork at ZRA Kazungula remains largely informal and reactive, which limits the predictability and accountability of teams.

The research further concludes that teamwork at Kazungula operates in an environment with many constraints. The most serious impediment identified is that different units have different performance targets; consequently, units compete instead of cooperating with one another. This structural misalignment of the performance management systems organizationally disincentivizes

sharing information and solving problems collaboratively across departments (Customs, Domestic Taxes, and Support Services). Other constraints also include inadequate resources, particularly information technology infrastructure, and ineffective interdepartmental communication. These obstacles to effective teamwork are negatively correlated with teamwork practices, which suggests that unsupportive organizational systems will decrease team effectiveness, even when team members are willing to collaborate.

According to the results of this principle study, it was demonstrated that good teamwork positively influences the amount of revenue to be collected by an organization. The extent to which good teamwork contributed towards revenue reported by the OSBP was quantified as a total of 45.3 percent of the total variance in revenue reported from staff members. This is endorsed because staff strongly agree that good teamwork lowers the risk of assessing errors (the taxpayers will have more accurate compliance), helps achieve monthly targets sooner, increases taxpayers' compliance to tax laws, and limits the amount of revenue leakages. This strong and direct relationship between teamwork and the amount of revenue collected confirms the conceptual framework used in this study and establishes the importance of implementing good teamwork as an operational strategy in the OSBP and not just an administrative concern. Additionally, the lack of differences in how well departments performed (no difference between departments on revenue results) demonstrates that when good teamwork exists, it has a positive effect on each employee to provide an overall system-wide value at the OSBP.

6.3 Recommendations

Based on the conclusions, the following recommendations are made for ZRA management, policymakers, and stakeholders involved in border management:

ZRA must revamp the performance management framework to set up collaborative Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for the Kazungula OSBP that include all three functional areas (customs, domestic taxes and support services). Team KPIs should be set up for revenue collection, clearance times and compliance rates, along with individual KPIs, to eliminate the rivalries that now inhibit collaborative efforts. Performance reviews should offer rewards for mutually exclusive performance (cooperating among the different departments) and information-sharing between

departments, and joint problem-solving in order to have all personnel incentivised to perform under the OSBP model.

The establishment of formal structures and processes to support team-based performance and the institutionalisation of teams should be priorities of senior management. The use of standardised agendas for weekly cross-functional departmental coordination meetings; the adoption of standardised operating procedures for collaborative processes; and identifying a team lead for each functional group's activities on multi-functional projects are three actions that will provide a more effective means of encouraging teamwork within ZRA. Increased clarity regarding roles and responsibilities will be achieved by implementing team charters that document inter-agency collaborative processes (e.g., joint audits; post-clearance verification; taxpayer outreach).

Third, ZRA must prioritise the investment in IT infrastructure and system integration at Kazungula that enables collaborative real-time access. Investments must be made in ASYCUDA and the stability of TaxOnline, in the procurement of adequate numbers of computers at Kazungula, and in the implementation of electronic workspaces that will link staff members from multiple functional units. Additionally, sufficient resources must be devoted to support services so that the support units do not become bottlenecks to joint team functioning.

Targeted training on teamwork and collaboration skills should be provided for all Kazungula employees. Training should necessarily incorporate topics such as conflict resolution, interdepartmental communications and collaborative decision-making within the context of revenue administration, rather than focusing only on generic teambuilding techniques. Managers and supervisors should also receive additional training on how to lead cross-functional teams and manage people in a team-based work environment.

Furthermore, the Ministry of Finance and ZRA headquarters should use Kazungula as a prototype location to establish best practices for managing borders through teams. The lessons learned should be used to develop national policy guidelines for use in OSBP operations, specifically the inclusion of measures of team effectiveness in the national monitoring framework for revenue performance.

6.4 Contribution to Knowledge

This study makes several contributions to knowledge in the fields of public administration, tax administration, and organizational behavior. Theoretically, the research extends Hoegl and

Gemuenden's (2001) teamwork quality model to the domain of revenue authorities in developing countries. The model studied here has been applied extensively in the project based and private sectors. This study demonstrates its applicability to the public sector border operations where teams are both permanent and cross functional. While the findings of this study support the extension of this model into the border operations of the public sector, they refine it by demonstrating that "organizational support" within the context of revenue authorities, is not simply a moderating variable in teamwork effectiveness, but rather serves as a key determinant of how the dimensions of teamwork translate into team effectiveness. In particular, IT infrastructure and performance appraisal systems are critical support elements that can facilitate or hinder teamwork success.

This study provides one of the first across Africa, quantitative assessments regarding teamwork and its impact on revenue collection within an African One Stop Border Post (OSBP). Specifically, this study demonstrates that teamwork accounts for 45.3% of the variance regarding revenue effectiveness; thus providing quantitative evidence regarding what has historically been discussed in the border management literature.

This study provides an understanding of a previously unrecognized barrier to collaboration for revenue authorities and serves as an actionable insight for tax authorities involved in the OSBP reform process. Furthermore, the identification of "competing targets" as the most significant barrier to collaboration contributes to filling a gap identified in the literature; specifically, this study contrasts with prior studies performed by Kang'ethe (2024); who conducted research at the Namanga OSBP, and focused on inter-agency teamwork rather than intra-agency teamwork and thus provides much needed contextual research findings to the border management literature.

The method used in this research effectively shows how a convergent parallel mixed-methods design can be used to measure both the overall amount of team-based working and challenges within working in a complex organization. The redesign of each existing validated measurement tool to fit the ZRA context produces replicable measurement tools for measuring teamwork at other OSBPs in Zambia and elsewhere in the region. For practitioners implementing the recommended evidence-based interventions, the framework for diagnosing issues related to specific dimensions of for creating team-based outcomes in an organization based on specific operational constraints and producing revenue will provide a means of using knowledge to plan interventions instead of

non-evidence-based or generic means of building teams. Collectively, these contributions to knowledge will further understanding of how evidence-informed practice can be applied to achieve a strategic advantage through teamwork for domestic resource mobilization.

6.5 Limitations of the Study

As much as this study has a lot of value added to the subject, there are several limitations that ought to be highlighted when interpreting the results of this study. First, the boundaries of the research were confined geographically to ZRA Kazungula OSBP, while the sample size of 50 respondents was appropriate for the station, the findings are limited in their generalizability to other border posts or inland ZRA offices which function differently. Second, to elicit the responses of employees to study questions, the study was dependent exclusively upon employee self-reported data. Due to the anonymity assured to respondents, they may have reported a greater number of positive behaviours relative to their colleagues, as they were likely to have adjusted for the possibility of being reported as bad team members and were likely to have been unwilling to share internal organisational issues faced by employees with someone outside of the organisation. Third, the study was focused more on internal organisational factors and less focused on external variables such as changes in tax policy or market conditions in the taxpayer's environment that influenced revenue collection. Fourth, the study design was cross-sectional in nature, therefore it only captured perceptions at one point in time and was unable to determine causality or track the evolution of teamwork as a result of the study interventions. Finally, the quantitative nature of this chapter means that the qualitative data obtained from the five qualitative interviews conducted as part of the mixed methods design were not fully incorporated into this chapter, which may limit the depth of exploration into the challenges referenced in this study.

6.6 Suggestions for Further Research

Future studies should tackle the limitations this study's results have found and look to expand on the overall findings in multiple ways. For example, additional research should occur comparing teams Mutli-Site OSBPs across Zambia such as those at Chirundu and Nakonde, to assess if any issues identified for teams at Kazungula hold on a national basis or regionally specific. A larger sample at the multi-site level would increase the ability to generalize the findings and will also allow for an examination of the difference between Border Specific and ZRA-wide impacts.

Conducting longitudinal studies would also be very useful in evaluating that the recommendations included in this study have been successfully implemented. For example, measuring teamwork practices pre and post-implementation of the recommendations, and revenue performance continues to build a sizable amount of data to identify causality and return on investment to the introduction of the team-based recommendations.

The third step is to incorporate objective revenue information with subjective measures into the future. The connection of self-reported skill level by the team to actual monthly collection statistics, accuracy rates and clearance rates will allow, through triangulation, for confirmation of the effect of team interaction upon revenue collections through documentation. Qualitative measures should conduct studies that determine how taxpayers interact with team-based service provision through an OSBP as the perceptions of the taxpayer are important for increasing voluntary compliance with taxation by the taxpayer. Additionally, future studies could assess how the ZRA and other border agencies, such as immigration, and the Zambia Bureau of Standards provide inter-agency service to increasing efficiency in trade facilitation and to facilitate additional revenue collection. These studies will develop an improved model of collaborative governance to support the provision of trade facilitation services and the collection of revenue.

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APPENDIX

Appendix A. QUESTIONNAIRE FOR ZRA KAZUNGULA STAFF

Instructions: This questionnaire is part of a study on teamwork and revenue collection. Your honest responses will help improve operations. Do not write your name. Please tick one box per statement.

Likert Scale Key:

1 = Strongly Disagree

2 = Disagree

3 = Neutral

4 = Agree

5 = Strongly Agree

Section A: Demographic Information

1. Department: Customs () Domestic Taxes () Support Services () Other: _____
2. Position: Officer () Supervisor () Manager () Support Staff ()
3. Years at ZRA Kazungula: Less than 1 () 1-3 () 4-6 () 7-10 () More than 10 ()

Section B: Objective I - Extent of Teamwork Practice

1. To what extent is teamwork practiced within departments at ZRA Kazungula?
2. My department encourages collaboration among staff to achieve revenue targets.
3. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
4. Team members in my unit share information openly to support revenue collection tasks.
5. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
6. There are regular team meetings to coordinate revenue collection activities.
7. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
8. My supervisor promotes collective problem-solving rather than individual work.
9. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
10. Roles and responsibilities are clearly defined when we work as a team.
11. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()

Section C: Objective II - Key Challenges Affecting Teamwork

1. What are the key challenges affecting teamwork in implementing revenue collection strategies?
2. Poor communication between departments hinders our team's effectiveness.
3. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
4. Conflicts over roles negatively affect teamwork in revenue collection.
5. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
6. Lack of resources limits our ability to work as a team.
7. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
8. Different performance targets across units create competition instead of collaboration.
9. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
10. Inadequate training on teamwork affects how we implement collection strategies.
11. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()

Section D: Objective III - Effect of Teamwork on Revenue Collection

1. How does effective teamwork affect efficiency and effectiveness of revenue collection?
2. When my team works well together, we meet our monthly revenue targets faster.
3. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
4. Teamwork reduces errors in taxpayer assessment and documentation.
5. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
6. Collaborative efforts have improved taxpayer compliance rates in our station.
7. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
8. Effective teamwork has reduced revenue leakages in my department.
9. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()
10. Overall, teamwork makes revenue collection at Kazungula more efficient.
11. 1 () 2 () 3 () 4 () 5 ()

Thank you for your participation.

Appendix B IN-DEPTH INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR FRONTLINE OFFICERS

Duration: 45-60 minutes

Recording: Audio recorded with consent

Introduction: Thank you for agreeing to this interview. My name is Chanda Mukuka and I am conducting a study on teamwork and revenue collection at ZRA Kazungula. I want to understand your personal experiences. There are no right or wrong answers, and you can skip any question. Your responses will be confidential.

Objective I - Extent of Teamwork Practice

1. Can you describe how teamwork happens in your day-to-day work? Please give me a recent example.
2. In your view, how often do staff in your department rely on each other to get revenue work done?
3. How does your supervisor encourage or discourage team collaboration?

Objective II - Key Challenges Affecting Teamwork

1. What makes it difficult for your team to work together when collecting revenue?
2. Tell me about a time when teamwork failed during a revenue collection exercise. What happened and why?
3. What departmental or station-level issues affect how your team collaborates with others?

Objective III - Effect of Teamwork on Revenue Collection

1. How has working as a team changed the way you collect revenue compared to working alone?
2. Can you share an example where teamwork directly helped you meet a target or solve a compliance case?
3. In your experience, how does teamwork affect errors or delays in revenue processes?

Closing Questions

1. What one thing would you change to make teamwork better for revenue collection here?
2. Is there anything else about teamwork and revenue collection you would like to add?

Thank you for your time and insights.

Appendix C KEY INFORMANT INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR SUPERVISORS AND MANAGERS

Target: 3 participants

Duration: 45-60 minutes

Recording: Audio recorded with consent

Introduction: Thank you for your time. As a leader at ZRA Kazungula, your insights are important for understanding how teamwork influences revenue collection strategy implementation. All responses are confidential.

Objective I - Extent of Teamwork Practice

1. How is teamwork structured and promoted within and across departments at this station?
2. What policies or practices has ZRA put in place to encourage team-based revenue collection?
3. How do you as a supervisor/manager foster collaboration among your staff?

Objective II - Key Challenges Affecting Teamwork

1. From a management perspective, what are the top 3 barriers to effective teamwork in revenue operations here?
2. How do issues like inter-departmental coordination, resource allocation, or staff attitudes affect team performance?
3. What challenges arise when implementing joint strategies with other border agencies at Kazungula?

Objective III - Effect of Teamwork on Revenue Collection

1. How do you measure whether teamwork is improving revenue collection efficiency and effectiveness?
2. Can you link any improvements in revenue figures over the past 2 years to team-based initiatives? Please provide examples.
3. What risks to revenue collection have you seen when teamwork is weak or absent?
4. How does teamwork influence staff accountability and revenue leakage?

Closing Questions

1. What recommendations would you give ZRA management to strengthen teamwork for better revenue outcomes?
2. Is there anything else you think is important for this study?
3. Thank you for your valuable contribution.